CHINESE SCHOLARSHIPS | COMPLETE BOOKLET

From First Email to Selection Notice

CSC, ANSO, Belt and Road / Silk Road, and the routes that are not for you yet - built around one real energy profile, with verified professors, contact routes, and paper links.

For: Muhammad Ismail
BS Energy Engineering, UET Peshawar (Oct 2023 - Oct 2027)
Target: Master's in China starting September 2028

What this booklet promises - and what it does not

It promises: a start-to-finish path for a Chinese master's scholarship - which route fits you, which universities and professors match your hydropower, solar, storage, hydrogen and smart-grid research, how to write to a professor, what documents each route needs, how to submit on each portal, and what happens after you submit, up to the admission and scholarship notice.

It does not promise: a scholarship, an admission, a deadline, or a supervisor's reply. China has no single scholarship form: CSC, ANSO, Silk Road and each university run their own calls, and every date below must be re-checked on the official call for your intake.

> **Read this first - no 2028 call was published when this booklet was written (4 November 2026).** Every date, stipend, age rule and seat number in this booklet is tied to a named past cycle (mostly 2026 or 2026-27, some 2027-28 university notices). Treat them as a pattern to plan around, never as a 2028 fact. The tracker in Chapter 21 is deliberately blank for 2028 deadlines. Fill it only from the published 2028 calls: HEC, campuschina.org, and each university's own notice.

How to use this booklet: Work through it in order once, then use Chapters 14 and 21 as checklists in the application season. Keep one folder per route and university. Never send the same study plan or the same professor email to two places with only the name changed.

Prepared 4 November 2026, from your profile as recorded in this conversation, from HEC, CSC, CAS/ANSO and university pages checked in November 2026, and from verified professor pages and publisher pages. Where a fact comes only from a secondary guide, this booklet says so. Sources and re-check dates are on the last page.

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One rule that runs through the whole booklet

> **Never invent a fact to make an application look stronger.** No invented FYP site data, no invented job, no inflated software skill, no claimed language score you do not have, no claimed publication, and no guessed professor email. Chinese universities and CSC check transcripts, references and supervisor letters. A single invented claim can end an otherwise strong application. Where your record is still in progress - Python, GIS, HOMER Pro, MATLAB - say so, and show the work you are doing to close the gap.

Words used in this booklet

Term	What it means here
CSC	China Scholarship Council, under China's Ministry of Education. Runs the Chinese Government Scholarship (CGS).
Type A / B / C	CSC programme categories. Type A: bilateral, via a nominating agency (for Pakistan, HEC). Type B: university-direct. Type C: designated programmes.
ANSO	Alliance of International Science Organizations. Its degree scholarship (CAS-ANSO) is hosted at UCAS and USTC and CAS institutes.
Pre-admission letter	A letter or notice from a university's international office, or an invitation from a school/supervisor, showing the university is willing to admit you. For HEC Type A, at least one is mandatory.
Agency Number	The code that tells the CSC portal which agency or university your application belongs to. A wrong number sends your application to the wrong place.
Self-funded place	An admission offer without a scholarship. You pay tuition and living costs yourself unless another funding source exists.

1. Your profile, honestly assessed

This chapter is the base for every route choice, university choice and professor email in this booklet. It uses only facts already in your record. Anything marked "to confirm" is not yet a fact you should state in an application.

Area	Your record	How a Chinese university / CSC will read it
Degree	BS Energy Engineering, UET Peshawar, Oct 2023 - Oct 2027, GPA 3.46	Directly relevant to energy, electrical, hydraulic and environmental engineering majors. A solid, competitive GPA - do not inflate it, and always attach the grading scale.
Final-year project	Feasibility study of low-head hydropower from the KP irrigation network; 12 canal sites; data from government departments; physics-first ranking, Random Forest as a comparative check only	Your strongest academic story. It links fieldwork, GIS, power calculation (P = rho g Q H eta), economics and irrigation reality. Lead with it in every study plan and professor email.
Field / industry experience	4-week WAPDA Tarbela Hydroelectric Power Station internship; project intern, Tarbela 5th Extension Hydropower Project (PCCCL, hybrid, from Sep 2026)	Real hydropower plant exposure: switchyard, turbines, generators, station operations. Rare for an undergraduate applicant - use it in every energy application.
Portfolio project	Energiscope (Pakistan energy dashboard); CanalPower PK starter pack (low-head screening tool, synthetic example sites only)	Shows you can build and finish something. Be precise: Energiscope's reviewed repo holds sample data, not a verified 10-year NEPRA dataset - never claim otherwise. CanalPower is a starter pack, not yet a finished repo - say so, and finish it before you apply.
Research exposure	Contributor to UET floating-PV research (floating vs ground-mounted PV benchmarking)	Useful breadth for solar / hybrid programmes. Do not claim a publication unless one actually exists with your name on it. Note honestly: no floating-PV specialist was verified for Chapter 11-12 - the closest verified fits are PV grid integration and PV-plus-storage professors.
Leadership	GIZ Pakistan Youth Ambassador, Sport for Development (2023-2025); AEE UET Student Chapter member / organiser (2023-present); SESA Campus Lead (2026-present)	Evidence of organisation and communication, not a substitute for academic fit. One line each on a CV is enough.
Skills in progress	Beginner Python; AutoCAD installed; MATLAB (R2025b), HOMER Pro, GIS still developing	State the level honestly, then show progress: a tested CanalPower module, a QGIS clipped DEM, a MATLAB model that actually runs. Progress beats a claimed "expert" level.
Languages	Pashto, Urdu, English - levels to confirm; no HSK stated	Do not copy any suggested level into an application. For English-taught programmes, take a recognised test (Chapter 16) or get exactly the proof the university accepts. For Chinese-taught programmes, HSK rules apply - see Chapter 16.

Your three gaps to close before the application season

1. **A finished, verifiable FYP result.** A completed feasibility ranking with sourced heads and flows, not a plan. This is your interview and professor-email material.
2. **One finished portfolio artefact.** CanalPower PK as a working GitHub repo with tests, real documentation and honest data labels - or Energiscope with its data credibility fixed. One finished project beats two half-finished ones.
3. **A recognised language score and a valid HAT score.** English test early enough to retake once (Chapter 16), and HAT at 50/100 or above for the HEC route (Chapter 3).

Four China-specific traps - read before you apply anywhere

1. Incomplete degree on the HEC closing date = not allowed (Type A). HEC's official rule is that applicants with incomplete degrees on the closing date are not allowed to apply. You graduate in October 2027, so a late-2027 / early-2028 HEC window should be safe - but only if UET's degree certificate is actually issued by that date. If it will be delayed, ask HEC in advance whether a provisional or expected-graduation certificate counts. Do not assume it does.

2. ANSO at both UCAS and USTC = automatic disqualification. You apply for CAS-ANSO through either USTC or UCAS, never both in the same cycle. Choose one host, and put your whole effort there.

3. The wrong portal, category, or agency number = a lost application. Type A needs both the HEC portal and the CSC portal (Type A, Agency 5861). Type B needs the university portal and the CSC portal (Type B, that university's number). Doing only one portal, or using the wrong number, is one of the commonest avoidable failures.

4. A May deadline is not a CSC extension. Silk Road university deadlines in the 2026 cycle fell in May, months after the general CSC December-March pattern. That is a separate, later route at specific universities - not a second chance to submit a general CSC application.

Your fit in one sentence (use this as your compass, not as a letter sentence): A Pakistani energy engineer who has stood on canal falls and inside a hydropower station, and wants to learn how China designs, models, stores and finances renewable energy systems - and then bring a tested, irrigation-first method back to KP's canal network.

2. What CSC, ANSO and Silk Road actually are - and what they are not

Route	Who runs it / where you apply	Master's headline package (past cycle - verify for 2028)	Best fit for you
CSC Type A	China Scholarship Council, via HEC (Pakistan nominating agency). Two portals: HEC + CSC.	Tuition, free dormitory or accommodation subsidy, monthly stipend, health insurance. Travel is borne by the awardee (HEC page). Stipend amount is not printed on the HEC coverage page; secondary guides consistently report CNY 3,000/month for a master's - verify in the 2028 notice.	Strong. Your main Pakistan route, if you meet the HAT and degree rules.
CSC Type B	Direct to a CSC-affiliated university. University portal + CSC portal (Type B + university agency number).	University notices show the same headline package: tuition, on-campus accommodation, living allowance, medical insurance. A secondary claim that Type B has "no monthly allowance" conflicts with university notices showing CNY 3,000/month - do not resolve this without the 2028 CSC programme page.	Strong. Your route to a named energy university and professor.
ANSO (CAS-ANSO)	CAS, ANSO and (for one PhD sub-category) TWAS/UNESCO. Hosts: USTC, UCAS, CAS institutes. Apply inside the host's own system, select CAS-ANSO.	2026 call (official): tuition waiver, master's stipend CNY 3,000/month up to 36 months, health insurance, application-fee waiver, one international trip, one-time visa/residence allowance. 100-200 master's students per year across the scheme.	Strong only if a CAS institute lab works on your topics and you secure supervisor interest. Lab-centred, not a general taught-master's route.
Silk Road / Belt and Road	Ministry of Education, under the CSC framework as Type B. Each designated university runs its own call and recommends candidates to CSC.	2026 university pages: tuition, on-campus accommodation, living allowance, medical insurance. CSU 2026: CNY 3,000/month master's, CNY 3,500/month doctoral.	Selective. Only at universities offering Silk Road master's places for 2028, for Pakistan, in an energy-relevant major. Check the country and major list per university - never assume.
UCAS Scholarship	University of Chinese Academy of Sciences, own award, parallel to CSC/ANSO at UCAS.	2026: Full tier - tuition waiver, stipend at least CNY 3,000/month master's in total (UCAS + institute/supervisor top-up), basic accommodation, medical insurance, fee waiver, up to 36 months, no extension. Partial tier - tuition + insurance + fee waiver only, no stipend.	Useful parallel route at UCAS. Check in the 2028 call whether one applicant may be considered under more than one UCAS scheme in the same round.

What these scholarships are not

- **Not a general "study in China" fund** you can spend at any university. You apply to a named university, a named major, and (for research degrees) a lab or supervisor.
- **Not a job, and not a guarantee of work after graduation.** They fund a degree. Post-study work rules are separate and country-specific - do not promise yourself a job in a letter.
- **Not buyable.** No agent can guarantee a CSC, ANSO or Silk Road award. Final decisions rest with CSC and the universities (and, for Silk Road, CSC expert review after university recommendation). Anyone charging a fee for a place, a pre-admission letter, or a supervisor contact is committing fraud - see Chapter 21.
- **Not one deadline.** HEC Type A, university Type B, ANSO and Silk Road each have their own windows. A missed university deadline is not extended by the CSC portal staying open.

3. CSC Type A through HEC: the Pakistan route, step by step

HEC is Pakistan's nominating agency for Type A. HEC states it is responsible **only** for nomination and selection under Type A. Applicants who apply directly under Type B or any other CSC programme are solely responsible for their own applications and correspondence.

The 2026-27 cycle, as published by HEC (pattern only)

- **Seats:** 75 total - 35 Bachelor's, 25 Master's, 15 PhD.
- **HEC portal deadline:** Monday 5 January 2026, 4:00 PM Pakistan Standard Time. Expect an autumn/winter HEC call for 2028; one secondary summary says HEC usually advertises around December each year.
- **Both portals are mandatory.** Apply on the HEC portal (scholarship.hec.gov.pk, "Learning Opportunities Abroad") **and** on the CSC portal with **Program Category: Type A, Agency Number: 5861**. Failure to submit on both = disqualification. No hard copies to HEC or the Embassy at that stage.
- **Programme length:** Master's 2-3 years, plus 1-2 years' preparatory Chinese-language study where applicable. Both Chinese- and English-taught master's programmes are available.

Master's eligibility (HEC official page)

- Pakistani / AJ&K national (dual nationality holders not eligible); good health.
- **Bachelor's degree (16 years) and under 35 at time of application.**
- Meet CSC portal requirements and the applied university's academic and language requirements.
- Not currently a recipient of any other scholarship.
- **At least one pre-admission document is mandatory:** a pre-admission notice from the international students' office **or** an invitation letter from the school / supervising professor. Applications with pre-admission letters are prioritised for placement at the issuing university. Secondary summaries that call this "optional but highly preferred" understate the official HEC wording - use the official wording.
- **HAT test:** HAT for Master's/PhD. Minimum **50 out of 100** or the application is not considered. HAT validity 2 years in the 2026-27 rules. Sit HAT in 2027 so a valid score of 50+ is in hand for the late-2027 / early-2028 HEC window, and check the 2028 HEC page for accepted test dates.
- **Language:** Chinese-taught master's/doctoral programmes require at least **HSK Level 4** (HSK 3 for general/senior scholar programmes). Verify language requirements with your chosen institutions and provide proof. No universal English-test score is stated on the HEC page - English-taught requirements are university-specific.
- **CSCA note:** The China Scholastic Competency Assessment is mandatory for undergraduate applicants. It is not stated as a master's requirement on the HEC pages. Do not apply CSCA to your master's application unless the 2028 call says so.

Review, penalties, and coverage (HEC official)

- First-round review by the Culture Office, Embassy of China in Pakistan (eligibility, documents, academic background, fitness, course choice, study plan, language; written tests or interviews may be held), then CSC review. CSC may adjust host university, field, category or duration.
- CGS recipients may not hold another government/university scholarship concurrently (one-time awards excluded). Concealment = termination, refund, and a 3-year application bar. Voluntarily declining a final admission may draw a formal warning and a 3-year bar.
- Coverage: tuition fully funded by the host university (education, administration and health insurance costs); free university dormitory or accommodation subsidy; monthly stipend "as per Chinese Government Scholarship policy" (amount not printed on the HEC page); **travel to be borne by the awardee**; HEC has no financial liability for this scholarship in any case.

4. CSC Type B (university-direct) and Type C

Type B - how it works

Apply directly to a CSC-affiliated university on campuschina.org with **Program Category Type B** and **that university's Agency Number**, usually plus a separate university-portal application. No HEC nomination, and no HAT requirement is stated for this route in secondary summaries. Secondary summaries say Type B applicants may apply to up to 3 universities on the CSC portal, and that a pre-admission offer or supervisor contact is commonly expected, especially for research degrees - verify per university, because some universities issue the pre-admission letter only after their own assessment.

University examples with agency numbers (verify for 2028 - do not reuse blindly)

University	Agency number (past cycle)	Note for you
Sichuan University (SCU)	10610	2027-28 cycle rounds: Round 1, 1 Nov - 15 Dec 2026; Round 2, 16 Dec 2026 - 28 Feb 2027. If Round 1 seats fill, Round 2 does not open.
China University of Geosciences, Wuhan (CUG)	10491	Application period 16 Oct 2026 - 28 Feb 2027 (secondary summary of a university notice, 2027-28 cycle).
Northeast Normal University (NENU)	10200	Type B deadline 28 Feb 2027, Beijing time (secondary, 2027 cycle).
Sun Yat-sen University (SYSU)	10558	Also a Silk Road host - see Chapter 6.
Nanjing University (NJU)	-	Applications open 1 Nov 2026; NJU application by 20 Jan 2027; CSC submission before 17 Mar 2027 for applicants with NJU pre-admission (secondary, 2027-28 cycle).
North China Electric Power University (NCEPU)	10032 or 10054 (secondary summary - confirm)	Energy-relevant: a secondary summary lists English-taught master's including Renewable Energy and Clean Power, Electrical Engineering, Mechanical Engineering, Environmental Engineering, and a PhD in Hydraulic and Hydropower Engineering. Confirm majors, agency number and deadline on NCEPU's own 2028 notice.
Central South University (CSU)	10533	Agency code from a secondary source only - verify.
Liaoning University (LNU)	10140	Agency code from a secondary source only - verify.

Coverage on Type B: university notices show tuition, on-campus accommodation, living allowance and comprehensive medical insurance. NENU and NJU notices state flights and family expenses are not listed benefits. One secondary source claims Type B covers "the same as Type A except the monthly allowance" - this **conflicts** with university notices showing a Type B master's stipend of CNY 3,000/month. Flag the conflict; do not resolve it without the official CSC programme page for the relevant cycle.

UCAS-specific note: UCAS recruits CSC scholars directly as agency number 80001. Its reported CSC totals are CNY 3,500/month for a master's and CNY 5,000/month for a PhD, because the supervisor/institute tops up the CSC base (master's +CNY 500, PhD +CNY 1,500). This explains why some UCAS pages show 3,500 for a CSC master's - it is a UCAS total, not the general CSC rate.

Type C - designated programmes

Described in secondary sources only as other CSC-administered or designated programmes (including short-term, provincial and special schemes), a smaller group, usually for researchers or exchange scholars. One secondary source calls Type C partial with few benefits. **No verified Type C master's route relevant to your energy profile was found.** Do not present Type C as a main master's route; check the CSC programme list in the 2028 cycle and include a Type C programme only if a named university offers it for a master's in your field.

5. ANSO Scholarship: UCAS and USTC, and the one-application rule

Previously "ANSO Scholarship for Young Talents", formally launched 2019. Jointly supported by the Chinese Academy of Sciences (CAS, major sponsor and leading founding member of ANSO), ANSO (a non-profit, non-governmental international organisation founded 2018), and TWAS/UNESCO for a PhD sub-category. A sub-category, ANSO-CAS-TWAS/UNESCO PhD Scholarship (launched 2022), selects up to 40 PhD students from developing countries per year, 10 prioritised for climate-related research, with special (non-exclusive) consideration for Least Developed Countries and women.

Hosts, scale, and 2026 call dates (official CAS institute page)

- **Hosts:** University of Science and Technology of China (USTC), University of Chinese Academy of Sciences (UCAS), and CAS institutes across China.
- **Scale:** Degree programme supports 100-200 master's students and 300 PhD students every year.
- **2026 call:** Opened 15 October 2025 (exact dates may differ slightly by host - check USTC/UCAS sites); **deadline for applicants and referees: 31 January 2026, Beijing Time.** A secondary guide checked 17 October 2026 reported the 2027 call had not yet been published. Expect a similar October-January pattern only - the 2027/2028 ANSO dates are not verified.

Coverage, 2026 call (official)

- Tuition waiver; **master's monthly stipend CNY 3,000/month, up to 36 months**; PhD CNY 6,000 or 7,000/month, up to 48 months, depending on passing the qualification test arranged by USTC/UCAS.
- Health insurance; application-fee waiver; international travel allowance/reimbursement from the home country to China, **one trip per awarded candidate**; one-time visa/residence-permit allowance.
- An awardee already on site in China at application time is not eligible for any travel subsidy. Annual assessment failure can mean scholarship termination, discontinuation of study, or a certificate of attendance instead of a degree.

Master's eligibility, 2026 call (official)

- Not hold Chinese citizenship; valid foreign passport; proficient in English or Chinese.
- **Born on or after 1 January 1996 (inclusive)** for a master's (PhD: on or after 1 January 1991). **Do not shift the 1996 cutoff forward and present it as the 2028 rule** - the next call's cutoff must be read when published. Check your own date of birth against that call.
- Meet USTC/UCAS international-student admission criteria; not take up other assignments during the scholarship; not currently pursuing a master's degree at any university/institution in China.
- **Language detail:** The official call excerpt says only "proficient in English or Chinese". Secondary summaries add English IELTS/TOEFL proof (native speakers exempt, no minimum score set in the 2026 summary) and HSK 5 with at least 180 points for Chinese-taught programmes. Do not quote a minimum IELTS/TOEFL score for ANSO.

> **Supervisor - a conflict to handle safely.** Secondary guides variously say a host supervisor is needed before applying, and that labs fill up before the January deadline (one advises writing to supervisors before December). A UCAS guide summary, however, says a supervisor is not strictly required before applying, though UCAS encourages contact and a signed Supervisor's Acceptance Form can accompany the application. Safe course: contact CAS-institute supervisors early and treat a supervisor/lab fit as practically essential, but verify the formal requirement in the 2028 UCAS/USTC call.

UCAS contacts from the official 2026 call: Master's programme - Ms. Lisha ZHOU, CAS-ANSO Scholarship UCAS Office, 80 Zhongguancun East Road, Beijing 100190, China, Tel +86 10 82674900, Fax +86 10 82672900, Email master@ucas.ac.cn. PhD - Ms. Yuchen XIE, phd@ucas.ac.cn (same address/phone).

6. Belt and Road / Silk Road, and two routes that are probably not for 2028

Silk Road - what it is

Chinese Government Scholarship **"Silk Road" Program**, funded by China's Ministry of Education, run **under the CSC framework as Type B** - each designated university runs its own call and catalogue and recommends candidates to CSC for final approval. Secondary summaries date the programme to 2017 - label that year secondary-sourced.

How to apply (two steps, university pages): (1) Apply on the host university's international-student portal and select the "Silk Road" programme; (2) apply on the CSC system (campuschina.org) with **Program Category Type B** and that university's Agency/Enrollment Code. Final admission is contingent on CSC expert review; university recommendation does **not** guarantee a CSC award.

Pakistan eligibility - use only the specific university's 2028 country list

University (2026 page)	Pakistan listed?	Major / note - check for 2028
Sun Yat-sen University (SYSU)	Yes	Eligible countries include Pakistan, Vietnam, Myanmar, Laos, Thailand, Cambodia, Indonesia, Yemen, Malaysia, Kazakhstan. Letter of Invitation deadline 17 May 2026.
Central South University (CSU)	Yes	But for Master's/Doctoral in Computer Science and Technology, Mining and Mineral Engineering, Transportation Engineering, Civil Engineering, Geological Resources and Geological Engineering. **No energy major was in that CSU 2026 list** - do not assume an energy fit at CSU. Deadline 20 May 2026.
Nanjing Forestry University (NJFU)	Yes	"Cultivation of High-Level Innovative Talents in Green Materials and Intelligent Construction"; Type B, School Code 10298; requires a supervisor acceptance letter signed/approved by the NJFU supervisor; deadline 20 May 2026. Adjacent to, not identical with, your energy topics.
Liaoning University (LNU)	Yes, but	The page found covered undergraduate students - do not use LNU 2026 as a master's example without a master's-specific LNU call. Application period to 18 May 2026.

Coverage (2026 university pages): tuition, on-campus accommodation, living allowance, comprehensive medical insurance; coverage subject to the CSC announcement in the same year (SYSU). CSU 2026: full package as tuition + accommodation + medical insurance + CNY 3,000/month master's / CNY 3,500/month doctoral. Secondary summaries add that visa fees, international travel and initial document-preparation costs are not covered - label those exclusions secondary-summarised, verify in the 2028 university call. Eligibility pattern: non-Chinese citizen, no criminal record, good health, excellent academic performance; master's under 35 / PhD under 40 in secondary summaries (same as the CSC pattern - verify per university).

Two routes to keep off your 2028 list unless you meet their bar

MOFCOM Scholarship (Ministry of Commerce, CSC Programme). Secondary summaries only - verify against an official call. English-taught postgraduate programmes at 26 designated universities in secondary summaries. Eligibility in those summaries: citizen of a developing country other than China; under 45; bachelor's for a master's; **at least 3 years' relevant work experience (described as non-negotiable)**; serving as a public official at department level or above, senior management, or academic backbone of a university/research institution; IELTS 6.0+ or TOEFL 80+ in secondary summaries. Coverage in secondary summaries: tuition, accommodation, research costs, living expenses, international travel; CNY 36,000/year master's (3,000/month equivalent). **Fit: poor for a fresh 2027 graduate applying for September 2028** unless you meet the work-experience and official/senior-manager criteria by application time. Your current record (final-year student; Tarbela internships) does not show that. Secondary sources also conflict on birth cutoffs - use neither as a fact.

Youth of Excellence Scheme of China (YES China). A full-scholarship CSC programme. Zhejiang University 2026 offers a Master in Energy and Power Engineering, 2 years ("1+1" mode), taught in English - directly relevant on paper. But eligibility (2026 university pages) requires a bachelor's degree **with at least 3 years' work experience** and one of four categories (senior government official, senior manager, university/research administrator, or relevant international-organisation employment/internship). Process: pre-admission letter first, then CSC submission with Type A, agency code 1563. **Fit: poor for a fresh 2027 graduate** for the same reasons as MOFCOM. Keep YES China as a "check again after 3+ years' relevant work" route, not a 2028 route, unless the 2028 call drops the bar (do not assume it will).

7. Your timeline: November 2026 to September 2028

No date below is a 2028 deadline. Replace every pattern date with the published 2028 call date when it appears. The order matters more than the exact month: supervisor and pre-admission work comes before portal deadlines, and the HEC Type A window is the least flexible.

When (pattern)	Do this	Do not do this
Now - mid 2027	Build the evidence base: finish the FYP to a verifiable result; keep one finished portfolio artefact (CanalPower PK / Energiscope honesty fix); keep grades and transcripts clean.	Do not start a CSC/ANSO application for a September 2027 start - you would breach HEC's incomplete-degree rule.
Mid - late 2027	Sit HAT (need 50+/100, 2-year validity in the 2026-27 HEC rules) so the score is valid for the late-2027 / early-2028 HEC window. Check the 2028 HEC page for accepted test dates. Prepare passport (validity 12+ months beyond the September 2028 start per the CSC guide), degree/transcripts, CV, and a 1,000+ word study plan per route.	Do not book a medical examination in summer 2027 - the Foreigner Physical Examination Form is valid only 6 months. Time it close to submission.
Aug - Nov 2027	Shortlist routes and do not mix them up: CSC Type A via HEC vs CSC Type B university-direct vs Silk Road university vs ANSO at UCAS or USTC (never ANSO at both). Shortlist universities and energy-relevant majors from the campuschina.org catalogue and each university's own list. Contact supervisors / international offices for pre-admission letters. Line up two professor/associate-professor referees early - ANSO referees share the January deadline.	Do not send one generic study plan to every university, and do not apply to a programme that is not eligible to admit CGS students - confirm this with the university's admissions office first (HEC advice).
Oct 2027 - Jan 2028 (pattern, ANSO)	ANSO window in the 2026 cycle was 15 Oct 2025 - 31 Jan 2026. Expect a similar autumn-January window; secure host supervisor and referees well before January. Apply inside the USTC or UCAS system, select CAS-ANSO, submit before the Beijing-time deadline. The UCAS Scholarship shared the 31 January pattern in 2026.	Do not apply to ANSO at both USTC and UCAS.
Oct - Dec 2027 (pattern, HEC Type A)	Watch hec.gov.pk/site/CGSP from October 2027. When the call opens: HEC portal application plus CSC portal application (Type A, Agency 5861), with HAT score, pre-admission document(s), study plan, recommendations, language evidence, medical form, passport, and notarised/attested documents. The 2026-27 HEC deadline was 5 January 2026 - treat December/January as the expected closing window, not a confirmed 2028 date.	Do not submit on only one of the two portals.
Nov 2027 - Mar 2028 (pattern, CSC Type B)	University Type B windows in 2027 examples ran November - February/March (NJU, CUG, NENU, SCU rounds). Submit both the university portal and the CSC portal (Type B + correct agency number) for each target university.	Do not assume a university deadline is extended because the CSC portal is still open.

7 (continued). Your timeline: November 2026 to September 2028

When (pattern)	Do this	Do not do this
May 2028 (pattern, Silk Road only)	Silk Road university deadlines in 2026 were mid-to-late May (SYSU 17 May, LNU 18 May, CSU 20 May, NJFU 20 May). Only for universities offering Silk Road master's places for 2028, for Pakistan, in an energy-relevant major.	Do not treat May as a general CSC extension.
Jun - Aug 2028 (pattern)	Results, admission notices, scholarship agreements, visa (JW201/JW202 process via the university/embassy as instructed in the admission notice), insurance, housing, travel. Budget for the flight yourself on CSC Type A (travel not covered).	Do not book non-refundable travel before your visa is issued, unless the university tells you to.
Sep 2028	Programme start (target, not a confirmed admission). Register at the time/place in the Admission Notice, or apply for an extension of registration. CSC scholarships are not reserved for late registration (HEC rule).	Do not let a scholarship lapse by missing registration.

Open question to check in the 2028 calls (do not assume): whether applying under both Type A (HEC) and Type B (university-direct) in the same cycle is permitted, and whether one applicant may be considered under more than one UCAS scheme (CSC / ANSO / UCAS Scholarship) in the same round. HEC's disclaimer (Type B applicants are "solely responsible") does not by itself answer this.

8. How to shortlist: route, university and supervisor filters, and the scoring sheet

Shortlisting for China is three decisions, not one: a route, a university and major, and (for research degrees) a supervisor or lab. Run every candidate through all six filters, and keep the evidence (a saved call page) for each pass or fail.

The six filters

1. **Route eligibility.** Does this route accept a fresh 2027 graduate from Pakistan? CSC Type A, Type B, ANSO and Silk Road can. MOFCOM and YES China require 3+ years' work experience and a senior category - they fail this filter for 2028 (Chapter 6).
2. **Major and subject fit.** Does the major actually teach what your FYP and career need - energy systems, power, hydropower, water, storage, grids, economics - or is energy only a word in the title? Read the semester-by-semester modules, not the brochure paragraph.
3. **Country and degree eligibility.** For Silk Road, is Pakistan on that university's 2028 country list, and is your major on its list? For every route, does the university admit CGS students in that major?
4. **Language.** What test, what score, and what exemption rule? A programme that requires HSK 4/5 with no exemption is a different plan from one that accepts an English-taught route with IELTS/TOEFL or an English-medium letter. Do not assume.
5. **Scholarship availability for your intake.** Is the programme offering scholarships for 2028, or only self-funded places? A programme near the end of its funding period may still be listed but offer no scholarship that year.
6. **Your evidence for that place.** Can you write a specific, honest paragraph linking your FYP, Tarbela work and portfolio to that major's modules and that supervisor's research? If you cannot, without inventing, it is not a first-choice application for you.

Scoring sheet (copy this for each route and university)

Filter	Score 0-5	Evidence (page, module, or call sentence)
Route eligibility (Pakistan, fresh graduate, age)		
Major / subject fit		
Language (can you meet it by the deadline?)		
Supervisor / lab fit (research degree)		
Scholarship for 2028 intake		
Your specific evidence		
Total / 30		**24+ = pursue first; 19-23 = backup; below 19 = watchlist or drop**

Red flags - drop or downgrade a candidate if you see these

- The call page does not state scholarship availability for your intake, or says "self-funded only".
- The curriculum has no module you can honestly link to your background.
- The language score is far above what you can realistically reach by the deadline, with no exemption route.
- The only reason to apply is the university's name or country, not its content.
- An agent or blog, not the university's own site, is your only source for a deadline or a fee.

> **How to use the official catalogues (5 steps):** 1) Open campuschina.org and the HEC CGSP pages. 2) Filter by field (energy, engineering, environment, water). 3) Open each university's own page from the catalogue entry - never apply from a blog link alone. 4) Save the call page for your intake as a PDF, with the deadline and documents highlighted. 5) Score it on the sheet above before you add it to your tracker.

9. Your shortlist: routes and universities to pursue first

Apply to 4-6 serious places in total across routes, each fully tailored. Do not apply to 20 places with the same plan. Start with the routes below, in this order, and add a backup only where your scoring sheet reaches 19 or more and your letter can be genuinely specific.

Priority	Route / university	Why it fits you - and what to verify for 2028
1	**CSC Type A via HEC** - your choice of CSC universities, with a pre-admission letter	Your main Pakistan route. Verify: HEC call dates, HAT window, Agency 5861, pre-admission requirement, and whether your chosen universities admit CGS students in your major.
2	**CSC Type B - North China Electric Power University (NCEPU)**	Energy-specialist university. Secondary summary lists English-taught master's including Renewable Energy and Clean Power, and a PhD in Hydraulic and Hydropower Engineering. Confirm majors, agency number (10032 or 10054 in that summary) and deadline on NCEPU's own 2028 notice. Also the home of Professor Nian Liu (Chapter 12).
3	**CSC Type B - Sichuan University (SCU)**	Strong water/hydropower school (Chapter 11, Professor Wang). 2027-28 rounds ran Nov-Feb, with Round 2 closing if Round 1 filled - apply in Round 1. Confirm agency code 10610 and 2028 rounds.
4	**ANSO - UCAS or USTC (choose one)**	Lab-centred route for a research master's, if a CAS institute lab works on your topics. Remember: UCAS or USTC, never both. Verify the 2028 age cutoff against your date of birth, and the supervisor requirement. UCAS contacts are in Chapter 5.
5	**Silk Road - SYSU or NJFU (only if the 2028 lists fit)**	SYSU listed Pakistan in 2026; NJFU listed Pakistan for Green Materials / Intelligent Construction in 2026. Both need a 2028 check: Pakistan on the list, master's places, and an energy-relevant major. Treat May deadlines as a late route, not a fallback for a missed CSC window.
Watchlist	CSC Type B at other energy universities (Hohai, Wuhan, HUST, Zhejiang, Xi'an Jiaotong, Tsinghua, Shanghai Jiao Tong)	These are your professor-directory universities (Chapters 11-12). Add a Type B application at one of them only if its 2028 call offers your major, accepts CSC Type B master's students, and you have a genuine supervisor or lab fit. A famous university with no major fit is a wasted application.
Not for 2028	MOFCOM and YES China	Work-experience and senior-category bars (Chapter 6). Revisit after 3+ years' relevant work, not as 2028 applications.

> **How to choose your final 4 to 6:** Start with Type A (HEC) and one Type B university where you have a supervisor fit. Add ANSO (one host) only if a lab fit is real. Add a Silk Road university only if its 2028 country and major lists fit. If two deadlines fall in the same week, stagger your work: finish the earlier-deadline application in full before you start the next one. A finished, tailored application beats two half-finished ones.

What about programmes not on this list? New universities and majors appear every year. When the 2028 CSC programme list and university calls are published, run any new energy, water or smart-systems programme through Chapter 8's six filters. A new programme is not automatically better than a shortlisted one - it is simply untested for your profile until you score it.

10. Professors: how to choose, and how to read a contact entry in this booklet

A professor email is useful only if the professor's research actually matches your study plan. A mass email to 20 professors with the same generic paragraph is worse than no email: professors compare notes, and a generic email signals that you have not read their work.

How to choose 4-6 professors to write to first

1. **Match the research, not the university name.** Pick professors whose recent papers use your methods or problems: low-head turbines, pumped storage, hydro-wind-solar hybrids, PV grid integration, flow batteries, hydrogen from intermittent renewables, or energy sharing and optimisation.
2. **Match the level.** A master's applicant should write to professors who supervise master's students in that lab or school, and say so plainly. Do not ask a professor to "be my supervisor" in the first email - ask whether your profile and topic fit their group, and whether they accept master's students for the 2028 intake.
3. **Read one paper before you write.** Name one paper, one finding, and one honest link to your FYP. That single paragraph is what separates a serious email from spam.
4. **Respect the contact status.** This booklet is strict about contact routes, because a guessed email bounces, goes to the wrong person, or embarrasses you. Read the status line on every entry.

Contact status - what each label means

Label in this booklet	What it means	What to do
Official university page	The email is shown on the professor's official university faculty page or an official university document.	Use it. Still verify on the page before sending, in case the page has changed.
Publisher / homepage	The email is shown as a corresponding-author email in a publisher paper, or on the professor's own homepage, with the university affiliation confirmed.	Use it, but double-check the university page first if one exists.
No public email found - department page	No public email was found on the official pages checked. No email has been guessed.	Contact via the department page given. Do not guess an address from the university's email pattern.

Gaps to be honest about: No professor from a CAS institute or from Dalian University of Technology is included, because none was verified to the same standard (name, email and paper) in the research for this booklet. Do not add one from a blog list. No floating-PV specialist was verified either - the closest verified fits for PV are PV grid integration (Yongheng Yang), PV plus storage (Donghan Feng, Guangchao Geng), and silicon PV materials (Deren Yang, in the "also verified" table in Chapter 12).

Paper links: Every paper link in Chapters 11-12 is a DOI link (doi.org) or a publisher page as returned by the research. Read at least the abstract before you cite a paper in an email. Never claim you have read a full paper you have only seen the abstract of.

11. Professor directory A: hydropower, water and solar PV

1. Ling Zhou - Hohai University, College of Water Conservancy and Hydropower Engineering
Research: hydropower stations, including pumped-storage power stations, and transient flow in water-conveyance systems.
Contact: **zlhhu@163.com** (official Hohai page). Profile: https://sdxy_eng.hhu.edu.cn/2018/0802/c11314a176628/page.htm
Paper: "Hydropneumatic storage methodology towards a new era of hybrid energy system's efficiency and flexibility", *Results in Engineering*, 2024. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.rineng.2024.103117
Fit: Strongest direct hydropower-station / pumped-storage fit; closest to your canal-fall and storage interests.

2. Weijia Yang - Wuhan University, State Key Laboratory of Water Resources Engineering and Management; School of Water Resources and Hydropower Engineering
Research: dynamics and control of hydraulic-mechanical-electrical coupling systems, large hydropower plants, variable-speed pumped storage, and hydro-wind-solar-storage hybrid systems.
Contact: **weijia.yang@whu.edu.cn** (official Wuhan page). Profile: http://jszy.whu.edu.cn/yangweijia/en/index/464520/list/index.htm
Paper: "Pumped storage hydropower operation for supporting clean energy systems", *Nature Reviews Clean Technology*, 2025, pp. 454-473. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1038/s44359-025-00057-x
Fit: Excellent - hydro-wind-solar-storage hybrids are exactly your FYP-to-systems bridge.

3. Chaoshun Li - Huazhong University of Science and Technology (HUST), School of Civil and Hydraulic Engineering; Institute of Water Resources and Hydropower
Research: control of hydropower, wind power and other clean-energy sets; condition maintenance of power-generation equipment; multi-source energy-system forecasting and planning.
Contact: **csli@hust.edu.cn** (official HUST page). Profile: http://english.civil.hust.edu.cn/info/1052/1468.htm
Paper: "Research on Reserve Capacity Optimization of Hydro-Wind-Solar Power Systems Based on Two-Stage Optimization", *Energies*, 2026. DOI: https://doi.org/10.3390/en19102324
Fit: Strong - hydropower control plus hydro-wind-solar integration and equipment maintenance/monitoring.

4. Wen-Quan Wang - Sichuan University, State Key Laboratory of Hydraulics and Mountain River Engineering, College of Water Resource and Hydropower
Research: fluid-solid coupling in hydraulic turbines, water-energy utilisation and hydropower generation, and efficient development of water kinetic energy.
Contact: **No public email found - contact via the department page.** No official Sichuan profile page with an email was found in the research; no address has been guessed. Contact via the Sichuan University College of Water Resource and Hydropower directory on the university site.
Paper: "Numerical investigation on vortex characteristics in a low-head Francis turbine operating of adjustable-speed at part load conditions", *Energy*, 2024. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.energy.2024.131800
Fit: Very relevant on turbines, and the 2024 paper is explicitly low-head Francis - but a second-tier contact until a public email or department route is confirmed.

5. Yongheng Yang - Zhejiang University, College of Electrical Engineering
Research: grid-friendly integration of photovoltaic systems and control of power converters, specifically grid-forming technologies for large-scale renewables.
Contact: **yang_yh@zju.edu.cn** (publisher correspondence, Zhejiang affiliation). Note: one other 2026 *Energies* paper lists yoy@zju.edu.cn for the same author/college - use yang_yh@zju.edu.cn as the primary address, since it appears repeatedly, and verify on first contact.
Paper: "Non-Intrusive Battery-Backed Grid-Forming Configuration for Grid-Following Photovoltaic Plants Retrofit", *Energies*, 2026. DOI: https://doi.org/10.3390/en19163728
Fit: Strong for solar PV grid integration, PV plus battery, and smart-grid interests.

12. Professor directory B: storage, hydrogen, smart grids and energy economics

6. Xi Xiao - Tsinghua University, Department of Electrical Engineering and Applied Electronics
Research: AC motor control, wave energy conversion systems, and energy storage systems, including hybrid energy storage and hydrogen-linked energy management.
Contact: **xiao_xi@tsinghua.edu.cn** (official Tsinghua page). Profile: https://www.eea.tsinghua.edu.cn/en/faculties/xiaoxi.htm
Paper: "Real-Time Energy Management of Hybrid Energy Storage System With Application to Wave Energy Converters: A Learning-Augmented MPC Strategy", *IEEE Transactions on Sustainable Energy*, 2026, vol. 17, no. 1, pp. 171-183. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1109/TSTE.2025.3591628
Fit: Strongest Tsinghua storage fit.

7. Bo Zheng - Zhejiang University, College of Energy Engineering, State Key Laboratory of Clean Energy Utilization (Deputy Director)
Research: electrochemical energy storage - supercapacitors/hybrid capacitors, high-power storage, and electrode-electrolyte interface engineering.
Contact: **bozh@zju.edu.cn** (official Zhejiang personal homepage). Profile: https://person.zju.edu.cn/en/zhengbo
Paper: "Ion desolvation for boosting the charge storage performance in Ti3C2 MXene electrode", *Nature Communications*, 2025, vol. 16, 3813. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-025-58700-x
Fit: Direct match for energy storage / batteries.

8. Weiwei Yang - Xi'an Jiaotong University, School of Energy and Power Engineering, Key Laboratory of Thermo-Fluid Science and Engineering (MOE)
Research: fuel cells, renewable energy, and energy storage - including redox flow batteries and metal-hydride hydrogen storage reactors.
Contact: **yangww@mail.xjtu.edu.cn** (official Xi'an Jiaotong University tutor list, confirmed as corresponding-author email in publisher papers). List: http://sie.xjtu.edu.cn/3.pdf
Paper: "Modeling and Simulation of Non-Aqueous Redox Flow Batteries: A Mini-Review", *Batteries*, 2023, vol. 9, no. 4, 215. DOI: https://doi.org/10.3390/batteries9040215
Fit: Strongest verified hydrogen plus flow-battery fit; also covers solar-linked storage.

9. Yinshi Li - Xi'an Jiaotong University, School of Energy and Power Engineering
Research: fuel cells, flow batteries, renewable-energy storage, solar energy, and heat/mass transport.
Contact: **ysli@mail.xjtu.edu.cn** (official Xi'an Jiaotong University supervisor list). List: http://sie.xjtu.edu.cn/3.pdf
Paper: "Carbon electrodes improving electrochemical activity and enhancing mass and charge transports in aqueous flow battery: Status and perspective", *Energy Storage Materials*, 2020. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ensm.2020.06.012
Fit: Strong for energy storage (especially flow batteries) and solar-coupled storage; also touches hydrogen/fuel-cell interests.

10. Donghan Feng - Shanghai Jiao Tong University, Department of Electrical Engineering; Deputy Director, State Energy Smart Grid Research and Development Center

Research: real-time market operation of smart grids with large-scale renewable energy and electric vehicles, electricity markets, and power system economics.

Contact: **No public email found - contact via the department page:**
https://faculty.sjtu.edu.cn/fengdonghan/en/index.htm

Paper: "V2G-enhanced operation optimization strategy for EV charging station with photovoltaic and energy storage integration", *International Journal of Electrical Power & Energy Systems*, 2025, vol. 171. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijepes.2025.111002

Fit: Best verified match for energy economics plus PV/storage integration (closest available to the floating-PV interest, but not floating PV itself).

12 (continued). Professor directory B - continued

11. Nian Liu - North China Electric Power University (Beijing), State Key Laboratory of Alternate Electrical Power System with Renewable Energy Sources
Research: smart-grid energy management, peer-to-peer energy sharing, and virtual power plant optimisation for distributed renewables and prosumers.
Contact: **nianliu@ncepu.edu.cn** (publisher correspondence - no NCEPU faculty page was opened in the research, so this is publisher-verified, not university-page-verified; do a quick NCEPU-site check before printing it as an official contact).
Paper: "Energy collaborative optimization strategy for virtual power plants participating in green electricity trading and peak regulation ancillary services", *International Journal of Electrical Power & Energy Systems*, 2025, vol. 172. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijepes.2025.111284
Fit: Best verified match for energy economics / system optimisation applied to distributed PV and storage.

12. Cheng Tang - Tsinghua University, Department of Chemical Engineering
Research: key materials for hydrogen production powered by fluctuating renewable energy, especially alkaline water electrolysis under intermittent wind/solar input.
Contact: **No public email found - contact via the department page:** https://www.chemeng.tsinghua.edu.cn/en/info/1019/1197.htm (the team is led by Professor Qiang Zhang and Associate Professor Cheng Tang).
Paper: "Heterointerface-Enabled Anti-Reverse-Current Electrodes for Alkaline Water Electrolyzers at 1000 mA cm-2", *Journal of the American Chemical Society*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1021/jacs.5c17603
Fit: Strong for your hydrogen interest, specifically the renewable-intermittency problem - but a second-tier contact until a public email is confirmed via the department.

Also verified - compact entries (check before writing)

Professor	University / focus	Contact route	One paper (DOI)
Guangchao Geng	Zhejiang, Electrical Engineering; power system stability, electrical energy storage, AI in power systems	ggc@zju.edu.cn (homepage genggc.org + publisher correspondence)	"Data-driven dynamic modeling for inverter-based resources using neural networks", *Nature Communications*, 2025. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-025-66604-z
Deren Yang	Zhejiang, Silicon / semiconductor materials; silicon solar cells and tandem devices	mseyang@zju.edu.cn (official Zhejiang page)	"Iceberg-like pyramids in industrially textured silicon enabled 33% efficient perovskite-silicon tandem solar cells", *Nature Communications*, 2025. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-025-62389-3
Yao Zhao	Shanghai Jiao Tong, School of Smart Energy; thermal / thermo-mechanical storage (Carnot battery, liquid-air, compressed-air)	No public email on the faculty page - contact via https://en.senergy.sjtu.edu.cn/index/faculty/98.html	"Thermodynamic investigation of a Carnot battery based multi-energy system with cascaded latent thermal (heat and cold) energy stores", *Energy*, 2024. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.energy.2024.131148

Not listed as a current Zhejiang professor, deliberately: Fushuan Wen. A CUHK Shenzhen page states he has been a research professor at The Chinese University of Hong Kong (Shenzhen) since 2026, and had been a full professor at Zhejiang University from 1997 to 2025. His older Zhejiang papers are real, but listing him as a current Zhejiang contact would be misleading. If you want to contact him, do so at his current institution, after verifying that page yourself.

13. Writing to a professor: rules and three templates

Rules for every contact

- **One professor, one question, one email.** Do not send the same mass email to 20 professors.
- **Do your homework first.** Read the professor's page and at least one paper's abstract before you ask a question its page already answers.
- **Thank them, even if the answer is "I cannot help".** Professors remember polite applicants, and the community is small.
- **Never pay anyone for "application help" that promises a scholarship, a letter, or a supervisor contact.** That is fraud, not networking.
- **Keep notes:** who you wrote to, when, what they said, and what you changed because of it. That note becomes interview material ("I spoke to a researcher about the storage track, and...").
- **One follow-up only,** after 10-14 days, if there is no reply. No reply after that means move on, politely.

Template 1 - First contact (under 200 words, adapt, do not copy blindly)

> "Assalam-o-Alaikum / Dear Professor [Name], I am Muhammad Ismail, a final-year Energy Engineering student at UET Peshawar, working on low-head hydropower from KP irrigation canals. I am considering applying for a master's at [University] for 2028, and I read your paper [Title] on [one specific finding]. My FYP ranks 12 canal sites by physics-first power calculation (P = rho g Q H eta), with seasonal flows and an irrigation veto, and I would value your view on one question: [one specific question, for example: does your group accept master's students working on hydro-wind-solar-storage hybrids for the 2028 intake?]. I understand if you are busy - thank you for your time either way. - Muhammad"

Template 2 - After a reply, one follow-up question

> "Thank you, that helps. One follow-up, if I may: you mentioned [module / track / lab direction]. In your experience, what preparation before September would have made that module easier? I am currently [one concrete step you are taking]."

Template 3 - Thank you, and closing the loop

> "Thank you for your time and advice. I have [applied / decided to apply to X / chosen track Y] and will let you know the outcome. If I can help a future UET applicant in the same way, please let me know."

> **The test of good use:** After speaking to a professor, you should be able to write one sentence in your study plan that you could not have written before, and name the paper, module or lab reality behind it. If you cannot, the conversation was general chat, not preparation - go back with a specific question.

14. Eligibility and the master documents checklist

Each route and university sets its own eligibility, documents and file rules. This chapter is your master list - tick off the route-specific version for each application, and never upload a document a route did not ask for in place of one it did.

Core documents (CSC guide + university pages; exact list varies by university)

[ ] CSC online application form (filled in Chinese or English, via campuschina.org).

[ ] Passport information page - if validity is under 12 months from the expected start date, renew before applying (CSC guide wording).

[ ] Highest diploma/degree certificate (notarised photocopy); a current student submits an expected-graduation / student-status certificate - but see the HEC incomplete-degree rule for Type A (Chapter 3).

[ ] Academic transcripts (undergraduate onwards), with notarised Chinese/English translations for documents in other languages.

[ ] Language certificate: valid HSK report meeting the programme's requirement for Chinese-taught programmes; IELTS/TOEFL (or other proof the designated university accepts, e.g. a university English-medium letter) for programmes taught in another language - university-specific, no universal score.

[ ] Admission documents for postgraduate applicants: admission letter, pre-admission letter, or supervisor invitation letter (CSC guide: these serve as a priority for admission; HEC Type A: at least one is mandatory).

[ ] Study/research plan in Chinese or English - **postgraduates no less than 1,000 words/characters** (CSC guide; USST page: same 1,000-word floor for a master's; doctoral proposals to be signed by the Chinese supervisor).

[ ] **Two recommendation letters** in Chinese or English from professors or associate professors, covering learning objectives in China, comprehensive abilities, future growth, and supervisor/university cooperation.

[ ] **Foreigner Physical Examination Form** - photocopy, completed in English, covering all listed items, with attending-physician signature, hospital stamp and sealed photograph; incomplete records are invalid; **results valid only 6 months**.

HEC-stage extras (reported in secondary summaries of the 2026-27 HEC pages - verify in the 2028 HEC call)

- HAT score card (50+/100); notarised/attested documents including Matric / Inter / Bachelor's, CNIC, domicile, birth certificate; police clearance issued within the last 6 months; NOC from employer if employed.
- Study plan minimum 800 words for Master's/PhD in the HEC shortlisted-candidate list. Note: this 800-word HEC figure differs from the CSC guide's 1,000-word postgraduate floor - **write to the higher, 1,000-word, standard to satisfy both**.

ANSO extras

- Apply inside the USTC or UCAS admission system and select "CAS-ANSO Scholarship" - there is no separate ANSO form.
- Referees share the January deadline in the 2026 cycle - brief them early (Chapter 17).
- A signed Supervisor's Acceptance Form can accompany the application (UCAS guide summary) - confirm the formal requirement in the 2028 call.

> **Before you press submit, run this 2-minute check:** Every required document uploaded? Every file opens as a PDF? Every file is the right route's version (not another university's letter)? Name and programme name correct on the letter? Deadline in Beijing time converted to Pakistan time correctly? If any answer is no, fix it before you submit - after submission, many portals do not allow edits.

15. Your CV and study plan: structure, and a worked skeleton

CV structure (2 pages is the usual target, unless the call says otherwise)

Section	What to put (your version)
Header	Full name as in passport, email, phone, city / country, LinkedIn or portfolio link only if it is up to date and honest.
Education	BS Energy Engineering, UET Peshawar, 2023-2027 (expected Oct 2027), GPA 3.46. Thesis / FYP title in full, with one line on method and outcome (once the outcome exists).
Experience	Tarbela 5th Extension project internship (PCCCL, hybrid, from Sep 2026) - duties, not just the title. WAPDA Tarbela 4-week internship - switchyard, turbines, generators, operations. Keep each entry to 2-3 bullet points with verbs and results.
Projects	Energiscope - with honest data labelling (sample data, not verified NEPRA dataset). CanalPower PK - screening tool, tested module, synthetic example sites, status (starter pack / repo, as it actually is at application time). Floating-PV research contribution.
Skills	Python (beginner, improving - with evidence), QGIS, MATLAB, HOMER Pro (developing), AutoCAD. State the level. A selector who finds an "expert" claim contradicted by a transcript or interview will downgrade the whole CV.
Leadership / service	GIZ Youth Ambassador (2023-2025), AEE UET Chapter, SESA Campus Lead. One line each.
Languages	Pashto, Urdu, English - with the test result once you have it. Until then, write "English: test scheduled / in preparation" only if that is true, and do not invent a score.

Study plan - five-part structure (1,000+ words, one per programme)

1. **Opening - the problem you want to solve.** KP canal falls carry water and head that is currently unused, while irrigation must come first. That tension - energy without harming irrigation - is the problem you want to learn to solve properly.
2. **What you have already done.** FYP: 12 sites, seasonal heads and flows, physics-first ranking, economics per site. Tarbela: plant operations and electrical systems. Portfolio: a tested screening tool and an energy dashboard, honestly labelled.
3. **Why this programme, this major, this supervisor.** Name modules, tracks and universities. This paragraph must change completely for every programme.
4. **Why you, why now.** Field and plant experience most applicants lack, plus a clear gap: formal system modelling, optimisation, storage or finance method at the standard this master's teaches. State the gap honestly - selectors respect it.
5. **What you will do after.** Return to KP irrigation / energy work with a tested screening method, or a research / industry role in decentralised energy - with a named type of role, not "serve my country" in general terms. Do not promise a specific job you do not have.

Worked skeleton - adapt in your own words, do not submit this skeleton

> **Opening:** "On KP's irrigation canals, water that must reach fields also carries head that is currently unused. My final-year project asks whether that head can generate power without harming irrigation timing - and it taught me that the engineering answer is easy, and the system answer is hard." **Evidence:** "Across 12 canal sites I ranked options by physics first - power from head, flow and efficiency, adjusted for seasonal flows and closures - and used economics and an irrigation veto as a second filter, not as an afterthought. At Tarbela I saw the other end of the system: a large station where switchyard, turbines and generators must work as one system." **Programme:** "At [University], [major / track] teaches the method I lack: [name two modules and what you expect to learn from each]." **Gap and contribution:** "I bring field and plant experience and a tested screening approach. I lack formal training in [system optimisation / storage integration / energy finance] at the level this programme teaches, and I want to close that gap." **After:** "After the degree I aim to return to decentralised energy work in Pakistan - applying a tested, irrigation-first screening method to canal and community systems, and working with utilities, developers, or research groups that build such systems."

16. Language: HSK, English-taught programmes, and your test plan

The two tracks - do not mix them up

- **Chinese-taught programmes:** HEC's official rule for Chinese-taught master's/doctoral programmes is at least **HSK Level 4** (HSK 3 for general/senior scholar programmes). ANSO secondary summaries add HSK 5 with at least 180 points for Chinese-taught programmes - verify per call. If you choose a Chinese-taught programme, your HSK preparation is a separate, long project: start it in 2027, not in the application month.
- **English-taught programmes:** No universal English-test score is stated on the HEC page. Requirements are university-specific: some accept IELTS/TOEFL at a stated score, some accept a university English-medium letter, some require a test score with no exemption. Check each university's own page, and save the sentence that states its rule.

Your plan (English-taught route, the realistic 2028 route for you)

Step	When	Target
Diagnostic practice test	Feb - Mar 2027	Find your weak skill (usually writing or speaking for engineering students). Do not book the real test until you know the gap.
Focused preparation	Mar - Jul 2027	Academic reading and writing practice, with timed essays on energy topics. Use your FYP writing as practice material - it is real academic English.
Real test, first attempt	Aug - Sep 2027	Aim for at least 0.5 above your lowest target programme's requirement, so a single weak skill does not sink you.
Retake, if needed	Sep - Oct 2027	Only if a target programme's deadline allows it. Check whether the programme accepts a test taken after the application deadline - most do not.

Exemption warning: Do not write "English medium" on an application and assume it is accepted. If a programme lists Pakistan, UET, or "degree taught in English" as an exemption, save that sentence from its call page. If it does not list it, take the test. A missing or invalid language certificate is an eligibility failure, not a minor gap.

Academic preparation that actually helps your applications

- **Python for energy data:** Finish the CanalPower module with tests, and one worked analysis of your FYP data (not synthetic data alone) that you can describe in interview.
- **GIS:** A clipped DEM, a mapped canal corridor, and a site map you made yourself, with a clear method note. A map you cannot explain is worse than no map.
- **MATLAB / HOMER Pro:** One model that runs end to end - a PV or hybrid system simulation with inputs, outputs, and a limitation note - rather than a list of software names.
- **Energy economics:** One clean LCOE / NPV / payback comparison across your sites, with assumptions stated. This is your energy-economics evidence for professors like Donghan Feng and Nian Liu.
- **Reading:** Read one recent paper per target professor's field before you write to them, and cite it properly in the email only if it genuinely shaped your thinking. Do not cite papers you have not read.

> **Budget for tests and applications (plan, not a promise):** IELTS / TOEFL fees, transcript and attestation fees, passport renewal if needed, and visa costs after selection are real costs. CSC applications themselves are free on official portals. Set aside the test fee early, and do not let a test fee delay force you to apply without a score.

17. Recommendations and pre-admission letters

A recommendation is not a favour letter. It is evidence from someone who has supervised your work, about specific work they saw, compared with other students they have supervised. A generic "he is a good student" letter helps very little, and a letter from someone who does not know your work helps even less.

Who to ask (in order, if they agree)

1. **Your FYP supervisor, Prof. Dr. Farid Ullah Khan** - the person who can speak to your project method, fieldwork, and academic judgement. Ask first, and only if he agrees.
2. **A supervisor or mentor from your Tarbela work** - the person who saw your plant / project work directly, not a senior name who never supervised you.
3. **A UET lecturer who taught you in a relevant, assessed course** (energy systems, power, thermodynamics, fluid mechanics, or similar) and can speak to your performance in that course, with a grade or rank if they are willing to state it.

Do not ask a family member, a friend, a politician, or a senior official who did not supervise your academic work. Do not ask the same person to write six completely different letters at the last minute - give them one briefing pack and a list of programmes and deadlines, and let them adapt the core letter.

Timeline and briefing pack (give this to each recommender)

When	What you give them
Jun - Jul 2027	A short, polite ask: would you be willing to recommend me for Chinese master's applications in autumn 2027? No letter yet, no deadline pressure.
Sep 2027	Briefing pack: your CV, your FYP one-page summary, the list of programmes and their deadlines, the portal link or referee form for each programme, and 3-4 bullet points of work they personally supervised that you hope they can mention.
At least 4 weeks before the first deadline	The formal request, with the earliest deadline clearly marked. Remind once, politely, one week before a deadline if it is still outstanding. Never submit a recommender's name or email without their permission.

Pre-admission letters - the China-specific extra

For HEC Type A, at least one pre-admission document is mandatory (Chapter 3). For Type B and ANSO, a supervisor invitation or acceptance form is commonly expected or practically essential. Treat pre-admission work as a separate task from recommendations: write to professors and international offices in August-November 2027 (Chapter 13), keep every reply in the programme's folder, and never submit a letter for one university as if it were for another.

> **Never write your own recommendation and ask a recommender to sign it, unless that recommender explicitly asks you to draft it and then edits it themselves.** If they ask for a draft, write only facts they can verify, and let them change it freely. A signed letter that is clearly not in the recommender's voice is worse than a shorter, honest letter.

18. Applying: portal by portal, and what happens after you submit

There is no single Chinese scholarship portal. Repeat the process, completely, for each route and university. A mistake in one portal does not affect another, but a rushed copy-paste across portals is how the wrong letter gets sent to the wrong university.

Step by step, per route

1. **Open the route's own application page** from the official catalogue or university site. Save the call page as a PDF, with deadline, documents, word limits, and language rule highlighted.
2. **Create the account early** - at least two weeks before the deadline - with the email you will check daily until September 2028. Do not use an email you lose access to, and do not use a different email for each programme unless you can track them all.
3. **Fill the form in the route's language and format.** Names exactly as in your passport. Degree title exactly as UET awards it. Dates in the format the form asks for.
4. **Choose your major / track carefully.** Many universities ask you to rank majors or supervisors. Rank by fit and evidence, not by country preference alone, and make sure your study plan matches the ranking you submit. A plan for Major A with a form ranking Major B first is a contradiction.
5. **Upload documents one by one, and open each uploaded file** in the portal preview if it offers one. Check: correct file, correct programme, readable, not corrupted, within the size limit.
6. **Enter referee details only after each referee has agreed.** Some portals email referees immediately. A referee who receives a surprise request is unlikely to write well, or at all.
7. **Review the whole application on screen** before you submit, against Chapter 14's checklist. Read your study plan once more, aloud, for that university's name and major.
8. **Submit, then save proof:** the submission confirmation email, a screenshot or PDF of the submission summary, and the application number. Put all three in that programme's folder the same day.
9. **Check the portal status weekly until selection.** If a document is marked missing or a referee has not responded, fix it through the route's stated route - do not email a coordinator with a new document unless the call tells you to.

What happens after you submit (typical stages)

Stage	What happens	What you do
Eligibility check	Degree, subject background, language, documents complete and on time. Incomplete or late applications are normally not ranked.	Nothing - unless the portal asks for a missing document through its own route.
University / institute review	Academic ranking: grades, relevance of your degree, quality of your study plan, recommendations, and any route-specific requirement (track choice, supervisor fit).	Check email daily, including spam. Reply quickly to any university query.
CSC / ANSO review (where applicable)	CSC expert review after university recommendation (Silk Road, Type B); CSC review after HEC nomination (Type A); USTC/UCAS review for ANSO.	Wait. Do not email repeatedly asking for a rank or chances.
Interview (some programmes only)	A short academic interview, often online, testing your motivation and your understanding of the programme - not general knowledge.	Prepare for 30 minutes, not 3 hours (see below).
Admission / scholarship notice	Sent by email, with a deadline to accept. See Chapter 19 for how to read that email.	Read it like a contract, slowly, twice, before you reply or tell anyone you have "got the scholarship".

> **Interview preparation (30 minutes, not 3 hours):** One sentence on your FYP question, method and result. One sentence on why this major and this supervisor, naming a module or paper. One honest sentence on a gap and how this degree closes it. One sentence on what you will do after. Then stop. Do not memorise a speech.

19. The admission and scholarship notice: how to read it, accept, and prepare to travel

The admission or scholarship notice is not a celebration message. It is a formal offer with conditions and a deadline. Read it like a contract, slowly, twice, before you reply or tell anyone you have "got the scholarship".

What a notice normally contains (check each item)

[ ] University name, major, and intake (for example, 2028-2030) - confirm it is the programme you applied to.

[ ] Your status: **selected for the scholarship**, **selected for a self-funded place**, or **waitlisted**, with your rank if stated.

[ ] Scholarship conditions: monthly stipend, duration, tuition waiver, insurance, and any condition (for example, degree certificate by a date, or language certificate).

[ ] Acceptance deadline, in Beijing time, and the exact way to accept (portal button, email reply, signed form).

[ ] Next steps: scholarship agreement, enrolment, visa support letter (JW201/JW202 process as instructed in the notice), and the contact person for questions.

[ ] What happens if you do not reply by the deadline (usually: the offer lapses and goes to a waitlisted candidate).

How to accept - in order

1. **Confirm the offer type.** "Selected" alone does not always mean "scholarship". If the notice does not clearly say scholarship, ask the coordinator in writing before you accept, and keep the reply.
2. **Accept within the deadline, in the way the notice asks.** Do not accept by a casual email if the portal requires a button, and do not press a portal button if the notice requires a signed form. Do both only if both are asked for.
3. **Decline other offers promptly** once you have accepted one scholarship. This is not just polite - it releases a place for a waitlisted candidate, and holding two scholarships can create a funding conflict.
4. **Save everything:** the notice as a PDF, your acceptance, the scholarship agreement when it arrives, and every later instruction, in one folder. You will need these for visa and enrolment.
5. **Ask for what you need, in writing:** visa support letter, insurance certificate, enrolment letter, and housing guidance, through the coordinator - not through a scholar or a social media group.

After acceptance: the next 90 days

Task	Notes
Scholarship agreement	Read it before you sign. Note the monthly amount, duration, and what happens if you withdraw or fail a review period.
Visa (first university's city)	Apply with the university's support letter, following the embassy's official page and the coordinator's guidance, not a blog timeline. Visa rules, timelines and documents differ by consulate.
Insurance	Confirm what the scholarship covers and what you must arrange yourself (for example, travel insurance for the journey, or cover between semesters).
Housing and bank	Ask the university's housing office and your cohort group. Do not pay a deposit to an unverified landlord from abroad without a contract and a university-recommended route.
Travel	Book only after your visa is issued, unless the university instructs otherwise. On CSC Type A, budget for the flight yourself - travel is not covered. Keep the scholarship's monthly budget in mind - it is a contribution, not an unlimited travel fund.
Pre-departure	Attend university and cohort pre-departure briefings. Pack originals and certified copies of every document you submitted, plus passport photos.

20. If you are waitlisted, rejected, or offered a self-funded place

Waitlist - what to do, and what not to do

- **Reply by the deadline** confirming you wish to stay on the waitlist, if the notice asks you to. Silence is often treated as withdrawal.
- **Do not stop other applications or plans** while you wait. A waitlist place is not an offer. Keep preparing other routes, and keep a backup plan alive.
- **Do not email the coordinator repeatedly** asking for your rank or chances. If the notice gives a rank or a timeline, trust it. One polite enquiry after the stated timeline has passed is enough.
- **If you are upgraded:** you will receive a new offer with a new acceptance deadline, which is often short. Check your email daily during the waitlist period, including spam.

Rejection - how to use it

- Rejection from one university does not predict rejection from another. Universities rank differently, and a university that rejects you for major fit may be followed by a university that selects you for exactly that fit.
- If a university offers feedback, ask for it politely, once, and use it for the next cycle. If it does not offer feedback, do not demand it.
- Do not rewrite your whole story after one rejection. Check the scoring sheet for that university: was it subject fit, language, letter specificity, or simply the number of scholarship places? Fix the specific weakness, not everything.
- Keep the rejection email. It proves you applied, and it is useful if you reapply in a later cycle with a stronger file.

Self-funded place - think before you accept

> **Do not accept a self-funded place on the assumption that a scholarship will appear later.** It usually will not. Before you accept, write down: tuition for the full degree, living costs in each city, visa and travel costs, and the funding source that covers all of them, in writing, with evidence. If you cannot write that down honestly, decline politely and keep the place as a lesson, not as a debt. A self-funded degree is still a good degree - but only if it is genuinely funded by you or by another scholarship you actually hold.

Backup plan (decide this now, not in August 2028)

If no Chinese scholarship arrives, your backup is not "try again with the same file". It is: (1) a stronger reapplication in the next cycle, with a finished portfolio, a higher language score, and a revised letter; (2) a funded master's through another route you have already researched (for example, a thesis-based master's with supervisor funding, or the Erasmus route in your companion booklet); and (3) energy work in Pakistan that builds the evidence for either route - with Tarbela, irrigation, or a developer - rather than a gap year with no energy work. Write your backup down in September 2027, before you need it.

21. Final checklists, tracker, fraud warnings, and sources

Application-season checklist (photocopy this page for each route and university)

[ ] Call page saved as PDF, deadline in Beijing time and Pakistan time written down

[ ] Major / track chosen and matched to the study plan

[ ] CV in the requested format, tailored to this university, no invented claim

[ ] Study plan within the word limit, university and supervisor named, read aloud once

[ ] Transcript with grading scale, degree / provisional document, passport copy

[ ] Language certificate or exemption evidence exactly as the call defines it

[ ] Referees agreed, briefing pack sent, portal invitations sent at least 4 weeks before the deadline

[ ] Pre-admission document or supervisor invitation, where the route requires or expects it

[ ] Medical form complete, signed, stamped, sealed photograph, within 6 months

[ ] Every uploaded file opened and checked in the portal preview

[ ] Submission confirmation email and application number saved

[ ] Portal status checked weekly until selection

Tracker (copy into a spreadsheet or notebook - 2028 deadlines deliberately blank)

Route / university	Deadline (Beijing / Pakistan time)	Major / supervisor	Documents ready?	Submitted?	Result / deadline to accept
CSC Type A (HEC)					
CSC Type B -					
ANSO - UCAS / USTC (one only)					
Silk Road -					
UCAS Scholarship					
Backup route -					

Fraud and safety warnings

- Chinese scholarships are not granted for a fee. Anyone charging for a scholarship place, a guaranteed admission, or a coordinator contact is committing fraud.
- Apply only on official routes: HEC portal + campuschina.org for Type A; the university's own portal + campuschina.org for Type B / Silk Road; the USTC/UCAS admission system for ANSO. HEC charges no application fee for the nomination process and bears no financial liability beyond nomination.
- Do not send passport scans, transcripts, or payment details to an agent's personal email or WhatsApp.
- Never share a password, a portal login, or a verification code with anyone, including someone offering to "submit for you".
- If a university's website looks different from its catalogue entry, or asks for payment before selection, stop and contact the university through its official university email.

Sources and re-check dates

Official starting points to re-check in autumn 2027: the HEC CGSP pages (hec.gov.pk/english/scholarshipsgrants/lao/CGSP); the CSC portal campuschina.org and the CSC application guide; the ANSO call pages at UCAS and USTC and the CAS institute call pages; each university's own international-student notice (Sichuan, NCEPU, SYSU, NJFU, CSU, Hohai, Wuhan, HUST, Zhejiang, Xi'an Jiaotong, Tsinghua, Shanghai Jiao Tong); and the professor pages and publisher pages linked in Chapters 11-12.

Scholarship amounts, deadlines and eligibility in this booklet were checked against HEC, CSC, CAS/ANSO and university pages in November 2026, and are tied to the 2026 or 2026-27 cycles (some university notices to 2027-28) - re-check them in the 2028 Programme Guide and each 2028 call. The CSC master's stipend of CNY 3,000/month is widely reported in secondary guides but is not printed on the HEC coverage page; the ANSO master's stipend of CNY 3,000/month is from the official 2026 ANSO call. Deadlines for the 2028 intake were not yet published when this booklet was written, and are therefore deliberately left blank in the tracker: fill them from each route's 2028 call, never from a blog list. Your profile facts are from your own record in this conversation (UET Peshawar, GPA 3.46, FYP, Tarbela, Energiscope, CanalPower, leadership). Language levels, test scores, and any publication are not stated in this booklet because they are not yet confirmed facts - add them only when you have the certificate or publication in hand.

Professor verification note: Professor names, affiliations, emails and papers in Chapters 11-12 were verified from official university pages or publisher pages in November 2026, with the contact status labelled per professor in Chapter 10. Emails labelled "publisher / homepage" or "no public email found" must be re-checked on the university page before you write. Do not add a professor from a blog list, and do not guess an email address.

> **Final word:** You do not need to be the best applicant in the world. You need to be a clear, honest, programme-specific applicant with a real project, a real major choice, and a real supervisor fit. Start with Chapter 7's timeline, score your routes in Chapter 8, write to four to six professors properly, and write one study plan at a time. Good luck - and keep the FYP first until 6 November.